

month. To do so, ask your service provider(s) and they'll let you know how it's done. In addition, you might have your paycheck sent directly to your bank account. This direct deposit makes the money available to you sooner, and saves you a few steps.

Staying Safe

Banking online is actually safer than traditional methods of banking. In fact, the U.S. government has been urging social security recipients to get their payments via direct deposit. There are fewer errors when you use technology, and there is less fraud. An electronic system makes it harder for scammers to intercept documents and forge forms. In addition, every transaction can be tracked in detail.

Staying safe online just requires a little common sense. Anything that looks fishy probably is; however, you can keep yourself from becoming a victim by keeping an eye out for the most common scams. The most common online scam is phishing. This happens when you receive an e-mail from a "bank" asking you to update your account information. They'll direct you to a website, which will ask you for your personal information, bank account numbers, usernames, and passwords. Of course, the site is not really run by any bank. It's simply a way to gather information from people who fall for the scam. Simply put, ignore these e-mails.



Some folks say they don't bank online due to security concerns. The fact is that their account information is already online—they've just never logged in. That doesn't stop somebody else from logging in, though. Better to control the account yourself!

You can delete any mail that comes from a bank that you don't remember opening an account with. If you happen to have an account with the bank referenced in an e-mail, don't just click on a link in the message. Instead,